

Jun Hyun Ji

Department of Economics, University of Pittsburgh

4700 Posvar Hall, 230 South Bouquet Street, Pittsburgh, PA 15260

junhyun.ji@pitt.edu | <https://junhyun-ji.github.io> | +1 (412) 519-2217

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Candidate in Economics, University of Pittsburgh	2021 – June 2027 (expected)
M.A. in Economics, Sogang University	2020
B.A. in Economics, Sogang University	2016

RESEARCH FIELDS

Fields: Microeconomic Theory, Decision Theory
Secondary: Game Theory, Communication, Information

JOB MARKET PAPER

“A Representation of Preference over Preferences and Choices”

I develop an axiomatic framework for preferences over choices, where an *evaluator* values each observed choice for its outcome and for the quality of the choice itself, which reflects her own assessment of how well the choice aligns with *good preferences*. I define “second-order preference” through an axiom capturing how choice quality is relative to available alternatives. Within the expected-utility framework, my axioms yield a unique representation that separately identifies the evaluator’s preference for outcomes and her second-order preference. As a special case, the model accommodates temptation and self-control as determinants of choice quality, generating a trade-off between achieving the best outcome and making the best choice. The framework provides a revealed-preference characterization of preferences over preferences, with implications for menu choice and welfare evaluation.

WORKING PAPERS

“Consistency and Strategic Disclosure in Model-based Persuasion”

Persuasion often works by supplying a model through which observed data are interpreted. I study persuasion when the receiver, beyond requiring that the model fit the observed signals well, demands that it be consistent, treating the signals as independent and identical draws rather than reading meaning into patterns. I characterize the persuasion cost of consistency in terms of the entropy of the empirical distribution of the signals, so that the more the signals differ from one another, the weaker the persuasive power. I then consider a sender who privately observes the signals and discloses only part of them at the time of persuasion, before the receiver sees the rest. When the signals are not all alike, the sender can avoid the cost of consistency entirely and fully manipulate the receiver’s beliefs. When they are all identical, disclosing more of them makes the signals easier to fit, but consistency limits how much this added evidence can work in the sender’s favor. The optimal disclosure is either a single signal or all signals; a single signal is best only when the receiver initially reads the signal as sufficiently bad news.

WORK IN PROGRESS

“Preference over Indifference”

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor, University of Pittsburgh

Game Theory Principles (ECON 0200)

Summer 2024, 2025

Teaching evaluation score: 4.65/5 (2024), 4.69/5 (2025).

Teaching Assistant (delivered class), University of Pittsburgh

Microeconomic Theory I (First-Year Ph.D.)

Fall 2022, Fall 2025

Teaching evaluation score: 4.68/5 (2022), 5.00/5 (2025). (Instructor: Jetlir Duraj & Luca Rigotti)

Introduction to Microeconomic Theory

Spring 2023, Spring 2024

Teaching evaluation score: 4.40/5 (2023), 4.34/5 (2024). (Instructor: Margarita Zabelina & Lester Lusher)

Mathematical Methods of Economic Analysis (First-Year Ph.D.)

Fall 2023

Teaching evaluation score: 4.84/5. (Instructor: Jetlir Duraj)

Teaching Assistant, Sogang University

Mathematical Economics; Labor Economics; Econometrics; Principle of Economics I

AWARDS, FELLOWSHIPS & HONORS

Art & Science Graduate Fellowship, University of Pittsburgh (2022, 2023, 2025, 2026)

Andrew Mellon Pre-doctoral Fellowship, University of Pittsburgh (2024)

Tamara Horowitz Memorial Fund Award, Department of Philosophy, University of Pittsburgh (2023)

Arts & Sciences Summer Fellowship, University of Pittsburgh (2023)

Reuben E. Slesinger Fellowship, University of Pittsburgh (2021, awarded to the most promising entering Ph.D. student)

Nam Duck-woo Economic Research Institute Scholarship, Sogang University (2020)

SEMINAR & CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2026	Midwest Economic Theory Conference (scheduled), Toronto Metropolitan University
	Microeconomic Theory Brownbag Seminar, University of Pittsburgh
	37th Stony Brook International Conference on Game Theory, Stony Brook University
	6th Durham Economic Theory Conference, Durham University
	PETCO (Pennsylvania Economic Theory Conference) poster session, Pennsylvania State University
2025	2nd Workshop on Choice & Welfare, Queen Mary University of London
	Microeconomic Theory Brownbag Seminar, University of Pittsburgh
	BSE Summer Forum 2025 (Choice & Decision Workshop)
2024	2024 Asian School in Economic Theory, Econometric Society, NYU Abu Dhabi
	Microeconomic Theory Brownbag Seminar, University of Pittsburgh
	PETCO (Pennsylvania Economic Theory Conference) poster session, Pennsylvania State University
2023	Pittsburgh Economics Medley Conference poster session, University of Pittsburgh
	Microeconomic Theory Brownbag Seminar, University of Pittsburgh
2018–2019	Applied Theory Research Center Seminar, Sogang University

ACADEMIC SERVICE

2023–2024	Mentor, Economics Graduate Student Peer Mentoring Program, University of Pittsburgh
2019	Seminar Organizer, Applied Theory Research Center Seminar, Sogang University
2018–2019	Study Mentor, Undergraduate Economics Study Center, Sogang University

PRIOR EMPLOYMENT

2015–2017	Data Analyst, Corporate Strategic Planning Team, Nuskin Korea
-----------	---

PERSONAL

Citizenship	Republic of Korea (US visa: F-1 Student)
Language	Korean (native), English (fluent)
Military Service	Sergeant, Republic of Korea Army (2009 – 2011)

REFERENCES

Prof. Luca Rigotti (Chair) Department of Economics, University of Pittsburgh (412) 432-9722 luca@pitt.edu	Prof. Cuimin Ba Department of Economics, Johns Hopkins University cba@jhu.edu
Prof. Richard van Weelden Department of Economics, University of Pittsburgh (312) 929-5135 rmv22@pitt.edu	

PLACEMENT OFFICERS

Dr. Andreas Ferrara Placement Director (412) 499-0819 a.ferrara@pitt.edu	Mr. Dane Youkers Placement Officer (412) 624-6094 dcyl4@pitt.edu
---	---